Garnsh

Menu publishing and control for multi-location restaurant groups

Business Plan v3.1 · 11 November 2026

Confidential. Prepared for the founders, advisers and prospective investors.

> **Status:** pre-revenue. Garnsh has a working product demo, no signed customers and no live locations. Toast access and the right to use customer credentials for public-facing menus are unverified. Every financial figure is modeled, not achieved. Targets are labelled as targets.

1. Executive Summary

Garnsh is a menu publishing and control platform for restaurant groups running 10 or more locations on Toast. It gives a group one place to prepare a menu, map it to each location, preview every guest-facing surface, publish deliberately, and roll back if something is wrong.

A group maintains one menu in Toast but presents it on four surfaces: its website, a hosted page, QR codes and in-store boards. Each is updated by hand. Prices drift, discontinued items linger, one location's prices appear at another, and a bad publish can leave a blank board during service. Nobody owns the problem end to end.

Gen 1 is the business: centralized menu management, per-location mapping and overrides, branded hosted menus and website embeds, QR menus, digital menu boards, preview and deliberate publishing, version history and rollback. It is not an ordering platform, a payment processor, a live inventory system, a loyalty product or a real-time sync engine. Ordering (Gen 2) and branded apps (Gen 3) are optional expansions, excluded from the base case.

The customer is a regional fast-casual or casual-dining group with 10–50 locations, all on Toast, with a brand worth protecting and a named owner for menu presentation. The buyer is the VP of Marketing, the Director of Operations or the founder-operator. Garnsh is sold on control, not on being the cheapest menu page.

Pricing is $59 per location per month for core publishing, $40 for menu boards, and a cost-recovery setup fee of $120 per location with a $1,500 minimum. The setup fee is a v3.1 change: a flat $1,500 loses money above 12 locations and badly at the top of the target range.

2027 objective. Sign 15 groups from 60 qualified conversations and 24 paid pilots: four free design partners for 90 days, six discounted showcase partners and five full-price customers. Reach 14 net groups and 192 live locations by December.

Financial headline — Scenario A, Gen 1 only, modeled.

	2027	2028	2029
Revenue	$45,946	$361,320	$918,657
Gross margin	77.2%	69.2%	76.6%
Operating expenses	$27,451	$168,100	$471,000
Economic result after founder labor	−$17,197	+$82,049	+$232,987
Cash from operations	+$25,643	+$142,529	+$326,227
Year-end cash	$45,643	$188,172	$514,399
Net groups	14.0	45.7	89.5
Live locations	192	615	1,182
Exit ARR	$130,278	$577,049	$1,177,318

Two facts matter more than the headline. 2027 is cash-positive only because the founders perform onboarding unpaid; valuing that time at $60 per hour turns +$25,643 of operating cash into a **−$17,197 economic result**. And the plan survives its base case with **$6,750** at the April trough, $1,750 above the $5,000 floor. Paying a contractor for 2027 onboarding pushes the trough to **−$1,878** and breaches the reserve; it needs about $7,000 of additional capital, not a large round.

The company is capitalized with $20,000 from the two founders and is not raising now. The milestones that justify a round are ten paying groups, six months of measured churn, a clear Toast position and a measured CAC.

What this plan does not claim. No signed customers, no live locations, no Toast approval, no certification, no measured churn, CAC or conversion. The product is a demo, not a production service. The first business test is whether multi-location groups will pay for menu publishing alone. Section 10 sets out the gates that decide whether to continue.

---

2. Problem and Customer

2.1 The operational problem

Each surface is maintained separately, usually by someone whose real job is running restaurants. The failures repeat:

- **Price drift.** Toast says $16.25; the website says $14.50. The guest who notices is a comp, a bad review and, in some jurisdictions, a consumer-protection risk.
- **Dead items and stale pages.** A discontinued item stays on the QR page for weeks, and the website menu is two cycles old, because removing either means editing every surface.
- **Wrong-location menus.** One location's prices appear at another.
- **No safety net.** A broken import or a bad publish leaves a blank board during service.

For a 10-location group this is a stream of small public errors multiplied by every surface, with no single person able to fix them at the source.

2.2 Why existing answers do not fit

Toast's native tools get an operator online; they are not built to give a brand team publishing control across an estate. The menu channel on Toast Websites is view-only, and Online Ordering runs on Toast's pages with limited customization. Garnsh does not claim Toast cannot display a menu; it claims Toast does not provide versioned, per-location publishing across surfaces it does not host.

Agencies build the site and maintain the menu by hand. They are the real incumbent: slow, expensive and the reason menus go stale — and a potential reseller channel.

Suites — Marqii, Popmenu, BentoBox, Owner.com, Lunchbox, ChowNow — solve listings, websites, ordering or marketing. Menu control is a feature inside a larger product, priced around ordering or marketing economics (Section 4.2).

The API wall. Toast's Menus API is real but gated. Standard access is read-only and location-specific; partner access requires an application and certification. Whether a customer's own credentials may lawfully power a public-facing commercial product is **unverified** (Section 7).

2.3 The initial customer

Ideal customer: a regional fast-casual or casual-dining group with 10–50 locations, all on Toast, with a brand worth protecting and a named owner for menu presentation. Multi-unit franchisees in that band fit the same profile.

Below 10 locations the pain is real but the budget and brand risk are small. Above 50 the security review and sales cycle exceed a two-person company's capacity. The plan starts in the middle.

Buyer: VP of Marketing, Director of Operations, or the founder-operator. **Triggers:** a price change that appears in one place and not another, a rebrand, a new location, a menu cycle change, or an agency handover. These are the moments when manual updating becomes visible and budget appears.

---

3. Product and Solution

3.1 What Gen 1 does

1. **Menu documents.** Ingest from Toast (when approved access exists), a CSV/Google Sheets import, or the manual editor.
2. **Per-location mapping.** Assign menus, prices and overrides to each location and surface, with a group view.
3. **Branded surfaces.** Website embed on the group's own domain, a Garnsh-hosted page per location, a QR phone view, and in-store digital boards.

4. **Preview and publish.** See every surface before publishing; publish selected locations deliberately rather than syncing silently.
5. **Recovery.** Version history, one-click rollback, and last-known-good serving if an upstream source fails.

The workflow is ingest → normalize → map → preview → publish → serve. The architecture is deliberately boring: an ingestion service, a publishing and versioning layer, and four renderers. The hard engineering is menu-data hygiene and publishing safety, not rendering.

3.2 What Gen 1 does not do

Gen 1 does not read or display 86 status, live stock or table availability. It is not real-time: a change reaches guests only when someone previews and publishes it. It does not take orders, process payments, run loyalty or provide a branded app, and it does not replace Toast as the system of record. These are product boundaries, not gaps for the next sprint.

3.3 What exists today

The current build is an interactive demo. It demonstrates per-location menu rendering, the preview and publish flow, version history and rollback. It is not a production service.

To be sellable it needs a production ingestion path and the CSV/Sheets bridge, tenant authentication and isolation, per-location asset management, board scheduling, an accessibility pass to WCAG 2.1 AA, and bulk publish with an unpublished-change alert. Without the last two, a 14-location group repeats the same click fourteen times and "deliberate publish" becomes a tidy name for silent drift. The estimate is 10–12 weeks of focused work for two founders; the 2027 plan is sized to it.

Capability	Today	At launch
Per-location rendering, preview, publish, version history, rollback	Demonstrated in demo	Production
Last-known-good serving	Architecture only	Production build required
Toast ingestion	Not built; access unverified	Conditional on Section 7
CSV/Sheets import, tenant isolation, audit log	Not built	Ship gate
WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility	Not assessed	Ship gate

3.4 Roadmap

- **Gen 1 (2027):** menu publishing. The only product in the base case.
- **Gen 2 (2028, gated):** ordering on the group's own site, writing orders into Toast through the certified Orders API. Requires certification and a commercial agreement. Not pre-sold.
- **Gen 3 (2029, optional):** branded mobile app and merchandise commerce for 25+ location groups, funded from revenue.

Gen 2 and Gen 3 are options, not the justification for the company.

---

4. Market and Competitive Position

4.1 Market sizing

The market is sized bottom-up from Toast's disclosed location count, not from a top-down software forecast.

Input	Value	Classification
Toast locations, Q3 2026	~189,000, +21% YoY	VERIFIED — Toast Q3 2026 results, 3 Nov 2026
Share in groups of 10+	10–20%	MODELED — no public breakdown
Serviceable locations	18,900–37,800	MODELED
Gen 1 revenue per location	$61/month	MODELED — $59 core + $2 boards
Gen 1 serviceable market	**$13.8M–$27.7M ARR**	MODELED
2029 locations in the plan	1,182	MODELED
Share of serviceable market	**3.1%–6.3%**	MODELED

The 10–20% band is a management estimate. Toast does not disclose how many locations belong to groups of ten or more; its enterprise push implies a rising share, the long tail of independents a low one. Better data exists in Toast's 10-K segment disclosure, franchise disclosure documents and paid datasets (Technomic, Datassential); buying it is a $5–15K decision the company has not made. The Gen 1 market excludes ordering, apps and payments. A 3–6% share of a $14–28M market is a credible niche, not a venture-scale outcome on its own.

Why now. Search engines and AI answer engines reward current, structured menu pages, and a PDF is invisible to them. Signage hardware is cheap, so the bottleneck is software. Labor turnover keeps recreating the "person who knew how to update it" failure. Toast adds roughly 8,500 net locations a quarter without Garnsh spending a dollar.

4.2 Competition

Prices are published list prices captured on 11 November 2026. They are not like-for-like: some are per location, some per brand, some per restaurant, and some bundle ordering Garnsh does not sell. The basis column is part of the comparison.

Player	Category and target	Menu capability	Price	Basis	Source
Toast native (Websites, Online Ordering, Delphi)	POS-bundled website, ordering, boards; Toast operators	Menu syncs from POS; website menu is view-only	Not disclosed; bundled	Per location, plan-dependent	toasttab.com; ressto.co (secondary)
Marqii	Menu management and listings distribution; multi-unit	Menu sync to Google, Yelp, Apple, Facebook; review tools	$90 / $145 / $180 / $250 per month	Per location, annual contract	marqii.com/pricing
Popmenu	Website, menu, marketing; independents and small groups	Dynamic menu, website, ordering add-on	$179 / $299 / $499 per month	Per location	get.popmenu.com/pricing
BentoBox	Restaurant websites and ordering; Clover-aligned in 2026	Website menu and ordering	~$119 / $279 / $479 website tiers; ordering ~$49/mo + $0.99/order	Per location, tiered; secondary	orderitto.com, getsauce.com
Owner.com	Website, ordering, apps, marketing; independents	Website menu tied to ordering	$249/mo + 5% of orders, or $499/mo flat	Per restaurant	owner.com/pricing
ChowNow	Commission-free ordering and websites	Menu tied to ordering	From $229/mo annual; setup $119–$499	Per restaurant	get.chownow.com/pricing
Lunchbox	Enterprise ordering and apps	Menu inside ordering stack	Quote-based	Enterprise contract	lunchbox.io
Web agencies	Custom sites, manual menu updates	Whatever they build, maintained by hand	Project fee + retainer	Quote-based	—

What the table shows. Garnsh is not cheaper than every competitor. Marqii starts at $90 per location and already owns distribution to the listings that drive discovery. Popmenu bundles a website and marketing for $179. BentoBox sells design. Owner.com and ChowNow sell ordering economics and can treat the menu as free.

Where Garnsh fits. None of them sells publishing control as the product: per-location mapping, preview before publish, version history, rollback and last-known-good serving, on a website the group already owns. Marqii is the closest adjacent competitor and should be treated as one; it could compete down into rendering or partner on distribution. Toast native is the default, not the enemy.

Why a group would buy, and why it might not. The alternative is an agency retainer, a marketing suite it does not need, or a coordinator editing four surfaces by hand; Garnsh costs $59 per location and removes a recurring public-error problem without changing POS, website or ordering vendor. But the problem may not be urgent enough for a separate product, Toast may ship enough, $59 may be too high for the value, or the integration may not be permitted. Those are the four tests in Section 6.

4.3 Differentiation, honestly stated

There is no technical moat in reading a menu API. Defensibility, if it develops, comes from switching cost once every location is mapped, from case studies in a narrow segment, from Toast partner status, and from a second POS adapter. None is strong on day one.

Claim	Status
Preview, publish, version history, rollback, per-location mapping	Demonstrated in the demo; production hardening required
Last-known-good serving	Designed, not built
Keeps the group's existing website, POS and ordering vendor	True by architecture
Toast ingestion	Not built; access unverified
Multi-POS (Square, Clover)	Not built; month-18 plan

5. Business Model and Pricing

5.1 Price

Item	Price	Basis	Status
Core publishing (hosted page, embed, QR)	$59 per location per month	Per location	MODELED — untested
Menu boards add-on	+$40 per location per month	Per location with screens	MODELED — untested
Onboarding	$120 per location, $1,500 minimum	2h per location at $60/h	MODELED — v3.1 revision
Multi-location management	Included at 10+ locations	—	—
Gen 2 ordering	+$99 per location per month	Per location	MODELED — conditional
Gen 3 branded app	$5,000 build + $149 per location per month	Per brand + per location	MODELED — conditional
Enterprise (25+ locations)	~$119 per location per month all-in	Annual contract, SLA	MODELED — untested

Every price is a founder assumption. None has been tested against an invoice.

5.2 What a customer actually pays

Line	14-location group
Core publishing	$826 per month; $9,912 per year
Core plus boards at every location	$1,386 per month; $16,632 per year
Onboarding, one-time	$1,680
Toast plan upgrade, if required	+$T per location per month — **UNVERIFIED**

If the group already runs a Toast plan that includes API access, the incremental cost is zero; if not, it may have to upgrade every location. At $50 per location a 14-location group pays $700 more per month — a 51% uplift on core plus boards and 85% on core alone. The first ten interviews must price this. The model excludes it; if it applies, the value story changes.

5.3 Setup economics

Onboarding is two hours per location at $60 per hour, or $120 per location. A flat $1,500 fee breaks even at 12.5 locations and loses money above that — at the 14-location average and badly at 40 locations.

Group size	Onboarding cost	Flat $1,500	Margin	Cost-recovery fee	Margin
10	$1,200	$1,500	+$300	$1,500	+$300
14	$1,680	$1,500	−$180	$1,680	$0

Group size	Onboarding cost	Flat $1,500	Margin	Cost-recovery fee	Margin
25	$3,000	$1,500	−$1,500	$3,000	$0
40	$4,800	$1,500	−$3,300	$4,800	$0

Options considered. (1) Retain $1,500 and cap onboarding at two hours: simple, but the cap is not credible for a 25-location group and the loss grows with the customer. (2) Raise the flat fee to $2,500: covers groups to 20 locations but still loses $2,300 at 40, and an unscoped flat fee is hard to defend in procurement. (3) Waive the fee as acquisition cost: better conversion, but adds $1,680 to every group's upfront cash on a $20,000 budget. (4) **Cost-recovery at $120 per location with a $1,500 minimum: breaks even at every size and does not tax the smallest customers. Recommended and adopted.**

The change adds $1,980 of 2027 revenue, $6,660 in 2028 and $10,080 in 2029 against the flat fee, and removes a structural loss on larger groups. The fee now scales with the work.

5.4 Pricing rules

No discount on the per-location price. Discount implementation instead: waive setup, add months, add a pilot location. A discounted rate compounds for the life of the account. The design-partner program is a capped, dated exception, approved by both founders in writing and recorded as marketing spend.

Validation triggers. Ten interviews, not three, before the price is fixed:

Trigger	Threshold	Action
Median acceptable price	below $45 per location	move to a $39/$69/$45 ladder and cut the cost base
Credential friction	3+ of 10 cannot supply Toast credentials	make CSV/Sheets the primary path
Pilot commitment	fewer than 4 of 10 accept a paid pilot	the segment or the pain is wrong; re-interview
86 status	top pain in more than 3 of 10	revisit the Gen 1 promise
Toast plan cost	+$25 per location for half the sample	the real price is $84+; retest the value story

6. Go-to-Market and Customer Validation

6.1 Validation status and funnel

Zero signed design partners, zero live locations, zero paying customers and zero interviews as of 11 November 2026. The funnel is a target, not a result, and every downstream number — revenue, founder hours, cash — depends on it. v3.0 used four sets of customer numbers that did not reconcile; v3.1 uses one classification and one funnel:

Stage	Count	Conversion	Note
Qualified conversations	60	—	40 in H1, 20 in H2
30-day paid pilots started	24	40% of conversations	Three locations each, $59/location
Pilots converted to annual	15	62.5% of pilots	Includes design partners
— Free design partners	4	—	90 days free, then list
— Discounted showcase partners	6	—	20% off core for six months, then list
— Full-price customers	5	—	List price
Gross groups acquired	15	25% of conversations	Model input
Churned groups	1.0	1.5%/month	Model output
Net groups at 31 December	**14.0**	—	Model output
Live and paying locations	**192**	—	13.7 average per group

The 15-group forecast requires 60 qualified conversations at 25%, not 40 at 25%. The v3.0 claim that 40 conversations produce 15 customers was arithmetically wrong and has been removed. At a 1-in-6 close rate the same 15 groups need 90 conversations and roughly 50% more selling time: a capacity risk, not a cash risk. Design partners and showcase partners are one program with two tiers, not separate pools, and no customer is counted twice.

6.2 Pilot and design-partner terms

Element	30-day paid pilot	90-day design partner
Eligibility	10+ locations on Toast, one brand owner, menu access and feedback	10+ locations, brand team, willing to sign reference obligations
Scope	Three locations, one embed, one QR view, one board	All locations
Price	$59 per location per month; setup waived during pilot, charged on conversion	Free for 90 days; setup waived; list price thereafter
Deliverables and conversion	Menu audit, three surfaces, training, written results; annual contract at list price	Case study, two reference calls, feedback; automatic annual contract at list unless 30 days' notice

Showcase partners: six groups at 20% off core for six months, then list price. Setup is charged.

6.3 What the v3.0 program would have cost

The original offer — four groups free for twelve months, six at 20% for twelve months, setup waived for all ten — is generous in a way the balance sheet cannot support.

Cost	v3.0 offer (12 months)	v3.1 program (90 days / 6 months)
Free subscriptions foregone	$40,992	$10,248
Discount foregone	$11,894	$5,947
Setup fees waived	$16,800	$6,720
Onboarding labor at $60/h	$16,800	$6,720
Reference and case-study time	$4,800	$960
Total economic cost	**$91,286**	**$30,595**

The revised program costs about a third as much and still produces four case studies, and it keeps the company inside its cash floor. The trade-off is real: 90 days may be too short to produce a publishable case study. If the first two partners cannot, extend those two by 30 days rather than reintroducing a twelve-month free tier. Reference rights are contractual requirements; the model does not assume every customer agrees, and a partner who refuses the case-study clause is a full-price customer instead.

6.4 Channels and founder capacity

1. **Founder network.** The founders operate in the Afro Deli franchise system: a source of introductions, not a customer commitment.
2. **Agencies.** They update menus constantly and dislike it. Offer a 25% recurring revenue share and a white-label option.
3. **Toast Partner Connect.** Only after approval; not in the 2027 plan.
4. **No paid acquisition.** A paid channel at $10–15K per group cannot be funded from $20,000 (Section 9.5).

Founder hours for 2027 total **1,464**, or 14.1 per week each on average:

Activity	Hours	Basis
Build	400	10 weeks × 40 hours total
Selling	324	60 conversations × 3h + 24 pilots × 6h
Onboarding	420	15 groups × 14 locations × 2h
Support	60	~1 hour/day from October
Admin	260	5 hours/week
Total	**1,464**	**14.1 hours/week each**

Quarter	Founder A	Founder B	Note
Q1	9.9 h/week	10.6 h/week	Build and first interviews
Q2	11.9 h/week	14.4 h/week	196 onboarding hours; 84 in June alone
Q3	7.6 h/week	10.1 h/week	Post-build, selling

Quarter	Founder A	Founder B	Note
Q4	11.5 h/week	14.0 h/week	140 onboarding hours plus support

The average understates the peak. In June three groups go live in one month: 84 hours of onboarding, 19.4 hours per week on that activity alone. The plan is feasible at part-time hours only if onboarding is capped at two groups per month.

6.5 Retention

Retention comes from switching cost: once every location is mapped and opening procedures reference Garnsh, replacing it means re-mapping the estate. The plan assumes 1.5% monthly group churn and 0.5% monthly location churn — assumptions, not measurements, which the first ten groups exist to replace with data.

---

7. Technology and Toast Integration

7.1 What works without Toast

The CSV/Google Sheets import and the manual editor can go live without Toast approval. They are not a temporary hack: they let the first groups pay before certification lands and remove the largest dependency from the first revenue dollar. The product is "menu document in, surfaces out"; Toast is an adapter, not the architecture.

7.2 Three kinds of Toast access

Route	What Toast documents	What it implies
Standard API access	Credentials are **read-only**, scoped to specific restaurants, **location-specific** (a separate request per location), with **no sandbox**. Menus `GET` is supported.	Enough to read a menu. Does not authorize commercial public-facing use on its own; that is a contract question, not a technical one.
Partner integration	Access is granted through the Toast Partner Integrations program, including a formal application and certification. Approved partners get scoped read/write access on behalf of customers who share data with Toast.	The only route that plausibly supports public publishing at scale and any Gen 2 ordering. Grants depend on the agreement and approval.
Custom integration	Menus `GET` is supported for custom integrations.	A per-customer build. Not a scalable product, but a possible pilot route with one design partner.

Sources, accessed 11 November 2026: Standard API access overview (doc.toasttab.com/doc/devguide/devApiAccessUserGuide.html); Partner integration overview (…/apiPartnerIntegrationOverview.html); API overview (…/apiOverview.html); Menus API overview (…/apiGettingMenuInformationFromTheMenusAPI.html).

7.3 The unverified question

A customer holding standard credentials can read its own menu. That does **not** establish that the customer may authorize Garnsh to use those credentials to power a public-facing menu inside a commercial SaaS product. That is a question of Toast's terms, the customer's agreement and possibly law. It is **unverified**, and no sale may depend on it until Toast or qualified counsel confirms it in writing. The same applies to partner fees, revenue share, certification timing and marketplace listing; none is assumed in the model.

7.4 The day-120 gate

By day 120 (May 2027), Garnsh must have all four:

1. a named Toast partner contact and a written application status;
2. a written timeline with dates for certification;
3. a sandbox credential, or a written reason none has been issued;
4. a written position — from Toast or counsel — on whether customer-supplied credentials may power public-facing menus.

If all four exist and (4) is yes, proceed on the partner route. If (4) is no, publish through CSV/Sheets and the manual editor only and start the Square adapter. If none exist by day 120, stop the Toast route and re-plan around import-first. "In progress" is not a status and does not pass the gate. The founders record the decision in writing.

7.5 Fallback and technical risk

Import-first is a complete product for a group willing to export a menu or maintain it manually, and the base case's safety net. A second POS adapter (Square, then Clover) by month 18 reduces single-platform risk. Menu-data hygiene — modifiers, price tiers, location variants — is the hard engineering. Tenant isolation and accessibility are ship gates: a failed accessibility audit is both an enterprise blocker and a legal exposure.

---

8. Operations and Founding Team

8.1 Team

Two founding partners. Names, backgrounds and the role split are **not yet documented** and must be completed before this plan goes to any external party. The table is deliberately blank rather than invented.

Item	Founder A	Founder B
Name	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]
Professional background	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]
Restaurant or restaurant-technology experience	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]
Product and engineering	Build lead: architecture, ingestion, publishing layer	Review, testing, accessibility and QA
Toast integration and certification	Partner application and technical contact	Fallback import path
Sales and partnerships	Agency channel	Sales lead: pipeline, pilots, close
Onboarding and support	Back-up	Primary owner
Weekly time commitment	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]	[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED]
Decision rights	Product and architecture	Commercial, pricing exceptions, hiring

Four functions need a named owner from day one: product and engineering, Toast integration and certification, sales and operator relationships, and onboarding and support. With two people each owns two; "we both do sales" means nobody does support during a Friday dinner rush. Before external circulation the founders must also supply employment history, restaurant operating experience, conflicts of interest and the equity split — not cosmetic gaps, because investors price them.

8.2 Support and hiring

Support becomes a founder's full day at roughly 150 live locations. The model budgets a part-time support contractor at **$2,500 per month** from that point, funded from revenue, which occurs in October 2027. Hiring gates are thresholds, not dates:

Hire	Gate	Model timing
Support contractor	150 live locations	October 2027
Engineer	$35K MRR	July 2028
Growth / account management	$50K MRR	October 2028
Second engineer, founder salaries	2029, from operating cash	January 2029
Founder pay	$0 in 2027; $6,000/month total from July 2028; $100K in 2029	July 2028

8.3 Legal and operating checklist

Before the $20,000 is spent: operating agreement with decision rights and a deadlock clause; four-year vesting with a one-year cliff; IP assignment from both partners, including the pre-entity demo; buy-sell and right of first refusal

with a valuation formula; trademark search and filing for "Garnsh" (USPTO classes 9 and 42); separate bank account and books; tech E&O and cyber insurance; contractor agreements with IP assignment.

---

9. Financial Plan

9.1 Model basis

The model is a 36-month cohort model. It tracks groups, locations, revenue, collections, onboarding labor, churn and cash, and separates cash from revenue recognition. It is a planning model, not a forecast. **Scenario A contains no Gen 2 or Gen 3 revenue.** v3.0's 2028–29 projections included 17%/28% ordering attach and 3.5% app attach, so they were not Gen 1 numbers; they are removed and modelled separately in Section 9.8.

Assumption	Base	Downside	Classification
Average group size	14 locations	10 locations	MODELED
Group logo churn	1.5%/month	2.5%/month	MODELED — no cohort data
Location churn	0.5%/month	1.0%/month	MODELED — no cohort data
Subscription collection	Same month (card on file)	30-day lag	MODELED
Setup collection	50% at go-live, 50% next month	Same	MODELED
Onboarding labor	2h/location at $60/h	4h/location	MODELED
2027 onboarding funding	Founders unpaid	Paid contractor	MODELED
Support contractor	$2,500/month from 150 locations	Same	MODELED
Price	$59 core, $40 boards	$59 core	MODELED
Toast plan cost to customer	Excluded	Excluded	UNVERIFIED

9.2 2027 by quarter

Quarter	Revenue	Cash from operations	Economic result	Cash at quarter-end
Q1	$0	−$13,151	−$13,151	$6,849
Q2	$8,085	+$3,033	−$7,887	$9,882
Q3	$19,487	+$11,535	+$6,495	$21,417
Q4	$36,854	+$24,226	+$15,826	**$45,643**

The trough is **$6,750 in April**, $1,750 above the floor. Peak capital deployed is $13,250; capital is returned by June. Monthly detail is in Appendix A.

9.3 The 2027 onboarding constraint

The 2027 cohort adds 210 live locations. At two hours per location and $60 per hour that is **$25,200 of labor**.

- **Founders perform it:** cash cost $0, economic cost $25,200, economic result **−$17,197**; the April trough is **$6,750**.
- **A contractor performs all of it:** the trough is **−$1,878 in June** and year-end cash is $20,443. The company survives the year but breaches the $5,000 reserve by about $6,900 and runs negative for part of Q2–Q3.
- **A contractor performs only the first cohort** (28 locations, $3,360): the April trough is **$3,390**, below the floor.

This is the binding constraint. The $20,000 works only if the founders perform 2027 onboarding, or if the company raises roughly **$7,000** to cover a contracted onboarding ramp. A $25,000–$30,000 requirement belongs to the combined stress case in Section 9.7, not to onboarding alone. That is a founder decision, not a modeling choice.

9.4 Three-year summary — Scenario A, Gen 1 only

	2027	2028	2029
Revenue	$45,946	$361,320	$918,657
Cost of revenue, excluding onboarding	$10,491	$49,011	$120,590

	2027	2028	2029
Onboarding labor (cash)	$0	$62,160	$94,080
Gross profit	$35,454	$250,149	$703,987
Gross margin	77.2%	69.2%	76.6%
Recurring gross margin before onboarding	77.2%	86.4%	86.9%
Operating expenses	$27,451	$168,100	$471,000
Economic result after founder labor	−$17,197	+$82,049	+$232,987
Cash from operations	+$25,643	+$142,529	+$326,227
Year-end cash	$45,643	$188,172	$514,399
Minimum cash during year	$6,750	$50,990	$193,782
Exit MRR	$10,857	$48,087	$98,110
Exit ARR	$130,278	$577,049	$1,177,318
Gross group additions	15	37	56
Churned groups	1.0	5.3	12.2
Net groups	14.0	45.7	89.5
Live and paying locations	192	615	1,182

The 2028 gross margin falls because onboarding labor becomes cash and sits in cost of revenue; recurring gross margin rises to 86%. The 2029 cost base is sized to Gen 1: $471K of operating expense, one engineer, one growth hire and a support team. The model adds 37 gross groups in 2028 and 56 in 2029 to finish with 46 and 90 net; a gross-add-only plan would overstate profit.

9.5 Unit economics per group

Definitions are stated because v3.0 mixed them. **CAC** is sales and marketing cost to acquire one group; **onboarding cost** is the direct cost of implementing it; **upfront investment** is CAC plus unrecovered onboarding; **payback** is months to recover the upfront investment from recurring gross profit; **LTV:CAC** divides LTV by CAC, not by upfront investment.

Line	Amount
Monthly revenue (14 locations × $98 blended ARPU)	$1,372
Recurring gross profit (89%)	$1,221
CAC (18 selling hours × $55 + $600)	$1,590
Onboarding labor (14 × 2h × $60)	$1,680
Less setup fee (cost-recovery)	−$1,680
Net onboarding cost	$0
Upfront investment	**$1,590**
Payback	1.3 months
Average life at 2.0% monthly revenue churn	50 months
LTV	$61,054
LTV : CAC	**38.4x**
LTV : CAC at 3.5% monthly churn	21.9x

Read this with suspicion. A 38x LTV:CAC is not a benchmark; it is the output of assuming 2% monthly churn, 89% gross margin and no support cost growth, with no cohort to test any of it. The honest use is directional: at these prices the economics work if churn behaves, and the constraint on growth is cash and founder time, not unit profitability.

Reconciling the v3.0 contradiction. v3.0 claimed on page 6 that CAC exceeds LTV and on page 13 that LTV:CAC was 38.4x. Both cannot be true. The intended point was about paid acquisition: a paid channel at $10–15K per group cannot be funded from $20,000. At a hypothetical $15,900 CAC, LTV:CAC would still be 3.8x — mathematically

acceptable, operationally impossible. The claim has been rewritten to say that, and the "CAC exceeds LTV" sentence removed.

9.6 Cash, working capital and the reserve

The base case assumes card-on-file collection in the same month and setup fees 50% at go-live, 50% the following month; receivables are $840 at the end of 2027 and $2,520 at the end of 2028. A 30-day subscription lag lowers the 2027 trough to **$5,570** — still above the floor, with $570 of headroom — and cuts 2029 year-end cash by about $40K. The plan should not assume same-month collection for enterprise accounts without confirming terms. The $5,000 reserve is a hard floor, not a buffer: below it, before recurring revenue passes $3,000 per month, the company stops discretionary spending, stops building and sells what exists.

9.7 Combined downside

v3.0 tested variables one at a time. v3.1 adds a combined stress case with simultaneous, correlated problems: 10-location groups, a 1-in-6 close rate (10 groups), launch delayed to June, 2.5% group and 1.0% location churn, 30-day collection, four hours of onboarding per location, and paid contractor onboarding.

Case	2027 revenue	2027 economic result	2027 minimum cash	2029 year-end cash
Base	$45,946	−$17,197	$6,750	$514,399
Downside (moderate)	$31,167	−$16,328	$6,325	−$9,354
Downside + cost response	$31,167	−$10,838	$9,205	$587,337
Combined stress	$16,741	−$35,894	−$16,194	−$292,456
Combined stress + response	$16,741	−$30,403	$7,085	$360,134

The combined stress is not survivable on $20,000. Cash goes negative in May 2027 and the company is insolvent before year-end. No cost cut fixes a business whose first customer arrives in June while a contractor is paid $4,000 per group to onboard.

The response. Founders perform all onboarding, including 2028, at four hours per location (cash saving $24,000 in 2027 and $52,800 in 2028); every hire is frozen, with no engineer, no growth hire and no founder draws through 2028; travel and marketing fall to $400/month each, contract design to zero, certification is deferred until the gate passes; the 2028 plan is capped at 22 gross groups; the support contractor is kept only from 150 locations. With those actions the trough is **$7,085** and 2029 ends with $360K — a smaller, slower, still-viable business, not the plan, at a cost of roughly two years of growth. The moderate downside breaches the reserve only in 2029 at the full cost base, and the same freeze restores it to $587K. If the founders will not run the freeze, the plan needs a bridge of **$25,000–$30,000** before launch.

9.8 Scenario B — conditional expansion

Expansion is modelled separately and never merged into Scenario A. Gen 2 launches July 2028 after a six-month build and certification; Gen 3 launches July 2029. Both depend on Toast partner approval and a commercial agreement.

Incremental line	2027	2028	2029
Gen 2 ordering revenue ($99/location)	$0	$25,528	$225,097
Gen 3 app subscriptions ($149/location)	$0	$0	$19,956
Gen 3 build fees ($5,000/brand)	$0	$0	$13,429
Incremental revenue	**$0**	**$25,528**	**$258,483**
Development and certification	$0	$75,000	$70,000
Incremental support	$0	$15,000	$45,000
Payment fees	$0	$740	$7,107
Incremental contribution	**$0**	**−$65,212**	**+$136,376**

Assumptions: ordering attach rises from 4% at launch to 22% of locations by December 2029; app attach from 1% to 3.5%; $10K per month of build for six months each; certification, security review and legal of $15K (Gen 2) and $10K (Gen 3). Adoption is modeled, not evidenced. Cumulative contribution by the end of 2029 is **+$71,164** — after $65K of investment in 2028 that the base case can fund and a smaller company could not.

No expansion revenue may be recognised before the product is built, certified and commercially permitted. If Toast denies partner access, Scenario B is worth zero and Scenario A is unaffected. That is the point of separating them.

---

10. Risks, Milestones and Funding

10.1 Principal risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation	Residual
Toast denies or delays access	No scalable feed; Gen 2 impossible	Apply in week one; day-120 gate; import-first; second POS by month 18	High
Public-facing use of customer credentials not permitted	Legal exposure; redesign	Written position from Toast or counsel before the first paid public page	High
No demand at $59	Revenue does not cover the cost base	Ten interviews before pricing; 60 conversations; paid pilots	Medium
Founder capacity	Build, sales and onboarding collide	1,464-hour budget; two groups per month onboarding cap	Medium
Onboarding paid by contractor	Reserve breached in Q2 2027	Founders perform it; otherwise raise ~$7K or halve the launch	High
Churn above 1.5%/month	LTV and growth fall	Annual contracts, quarterly reviews, measure from cohort one	Medium
Collection lag	Trough breaches floor	Card on file; setup at signing; deposits for enterprise terms	Low
Toast ships a native equivalent	Differentiation erodes	Publishing craft, multi-surface, agency channel; no moat claimed	Medium
Accessibility or legal exposure	Enterprise blocker; ADA claim	WCAG 2.1 AA ship gate; E&O insurance; contract terms	Low

10.2 2027 milestones

When	Milestone
Week 1	Entity formed; $20,000 paid in; operating agreement, vesting and IP assignment signed; Toast partner application submitted
Jan–Mar	Build Gen 1; ship CSV/Sheets bridge; 40-group target list; pricing interviews; legal checkpoint on credentials
15 Mar	First design partner signed. If not, freeze travel and demos, defer certification, cut launch scope
Mar–Jun	Ten groups live; pilots running; first case study drafted
Day 120 (~May)	Toast gate: all four tests documented
Day 180	Sales gate: at least 4 design partners signed and 3 paying, or the ICP, price or motion is wrong
H2 2027	Remaining five groups; six showcase partners; agency referrals
Dec 2027	14 net groups, 192 live locations, $45,946 revenue, $6,750 trough, $45,643 cash

10.3 Gates and kill criteria

- **Day 120 Toast gate:** all four tests, documented. Fail means import-first and a re-plan, not "in progress".
- **Day 180 sales gate:** fewer than 4 design partners signed, or fewer than 3 paying, means the ICP, price or motion is wrong. Do not add features; re-interview.
- **Cash floor:** below $5,000 before $3,000/month recurring revenue means stop and sell.
- **Gross margin:** below 75% recurring at 100 live locations for two consecutive months means the unit economics are broken. At 100 locations and 2h/location the model shows 77.9%; at 4h, 61.5%.
- **Churn:** above 3% monthly group churn after 25 groups means the product is not embedded; stop marketing and fix onboarding.

10.4 Funding strategy

The company is not raising now. The milestones that justify a round are ten paying groups and roughly 140 paying locations; at least six months of measured churn; a clear Toast status; a CAC and payback measured from real cohorts; and one 20+ location group on an annual contract. A round at that point funds engineering, certification and the first sales hire. It does not fund survival.

If the founders cannot perform 2027 onboarding, the bridge requirement is about **$7,000**. If the combined stress case materialises before the first raise, it is **$25,000–$30,000**. Either way the right instrument is a small convertible note or founder loan, not a priced round.

---

11. Conclusion

Garnsh is a narrow, credible Gen 1 business: menu publishing and control for multi-location Toast groups. The problem is real, the product boundary is honest, and the unit economics work if the price holds and churn behaves. The risks are Toast access, demand and founder capacity — not the arithmetic.

The plan is deliberately small. It does not assume ordering, payments or a branded app. It does not assume customers it does not have. It assumes two founders can build a useful product, sell fifteen groups, and learn whether the market will pay $59 per location before spending money the company does not have.

That is the right test. If it passes, Garnsh has a business worth scaling. If it fails, it fails cheaply, with the evidence written down.

Appendix A — 2027 monthly schedule (Scenario A)

Month	Live loc	Paying loc	Revenue	Cash from ops	Economic result	Cash
Jan	0	0	$0	−$4,617	−$4,617	$15,383
Feb	0	0	$0	−$5,617	−$5,617	$9,766
Mar	0	0	$0	−$2,917	−$2,917	$6,849
Apr	28	14	$2,024	−$99	−$2,619	$6,750
May	55	28	$2,699	$1,349	−$2,011	$8,099
Jun	96	41	$3,361	$1,783	−$3,257	$9,882
Jul	108	68	$4,814	$3,299	$1,619	$13,181
Aug	120	93	$6,237	$5,160	$3,480	$18,341
Sep	132	132	$8,436	$3,076	$1,396	$21,417
Oct	157	157	$11,319	$6,753	$4,233	$28,170
Nov	182	182	$12,998	$7,980	$4,620	$36,150
Dec	192	192	$12,537	$9,493	$6,973	$45,643

Paying locations reach live locations in September because every free design partner has passed its 90-day period. Revenue includes $18,480 of setup fees, collected 50% at go-live and 50% the following month, which is why December revenue is below November despite more paying locations.

Appendix B — Sensitivities

Case	2027 revenue	2027 economic result	Lowest cash	Month
Base	$45,946	−$17,197	$6,750	Apr
Group size 10	$32,818	−$14,769	$6,571	Apr
Close 1 in 6 (10 groups)	$24,457	−$21,510	$4,100	Jun
Launch delayed to June	$25,451	−$26,450	$4,100	Jun
Churn 2.5% / 1.0%	$43,634	−$16,879	$6,750	Apr

Case	2027 revenue	2027 economic result	Lowest cash	Month
30-day collection lag	$45,946	−$17,197	$6,405	Apr
Paid 2027 onboarding	$45,946	−$17,197	−$1,878	Jun
Onboarding 4h/location	$45,946	−$42,397	$6,750	Apr
Core price $45	$35,437	−$27,400	$6,673	Apr
Setup flat $1,500	$45,946	−$17,197	$6,660	Apr
Setup $2,500	$45,946	−$17,197	$6,849	Mar

Appendix C — Evidence register (summary)

The full register is a separate deliverable. Claims are classified VERIFIED, MODELED, UNVERIFIED, TARGET or ACTUAL.

VERIFIED. Toast had ~189,000 locations at 30 September 2026, +21% year over year, ARR $2.5B and ~8,500 net adds in Q3 2026 (Toast Q3 2026 results, 3 November 2026). Standard API access is read-only, location-specific, and excludes write access and sandbox. Partner access requires a formal application and certification, with scoped read/write access. Menus `GET` is supported for partner, custom and standard integrations (Toast developer guide, accessed 11 November 2026). Published competitor prices in Section 4.2, as at 11 November 2026.

MODELED. 10–20% of Toast locations in groups of 10+; serviceable market $13.8M–$27.7M; all pricing, attach rates, churn, CAC, onboarding hours, conversion and financial results; founder hours and the 2027 funnel.

UNVERIFIED. Whether customer-supplied Toast credentials may power public-facing menus in a commercial product; partner fees, revenue share and certification timeline; the customer's incremental Toast plan cost; demand at $59; churn; CAC; pilot conversion; competitor prices where only secondary sources exist (BentoBox, Popmenu add-ons, Lunchbox).

TARGET. 15 gross groups, 14 net groups, 192 live locations and 60 conversations in 2027; Gen 2 launch July 2028; Gen 3 launch July 2029.

ACTUAL. Two founders, $20,000 committed capital, a working demo. Nothing else.

Appendix D — Sources

1. Toast, Inc., Toast Announces Third Quarter 2026 Financial Results, 3 November 2026 — investors.toasttab.com; businesswire.com.
2. Toast developer guide, Standard API access overview — https://doc.toasttab.com/doc/devguide/devApiAccessUserGuide.html (accessed 11 November 2026).
3. Toast developer guide, Partner integration overview — https://doc.toasttab.com/doc/devguide/apiPartnerIntegrationOverview.html (accessed 11 November 2026).
4. Toast developer guide, API overview — https://doc.toasttab.com/doc/devguide/apiOverview.html (accessed 11 November 2026).
5. Toast developer guide, Menus API overview — https://doc.toasttab.com/doc/devguide/apiGettingMenuInformationFromTheMenusAPI.html (accessed 11 November 2026).
6. Marqii, Pricing — https://marqii.com/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026).
7. Popmenu, Pricing — https://get.popmenu.com/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026).
8. Owner.com, Pricing — https://www.owner.com/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026).
9. ChowNow, Plans and pricing — https://get.chownow.com/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026).
10. BentoBox pricing summaries — orderitto.com; getsauce.com (secondary, 2026).
11. Founders' working notes and the Garnsh demo, November 2026.

Where a claim is not sourced above, it is an assumption and is labelled MODELED or UNVERIFIED in the register.